

UzbekTrip — Brand Book

Version 1.0 — June 2026

1. Brand Positioning

What we are: The most complete, independently-written travel guide to Uzbekistan — built for the moment Uzbekistan became one of the fastest-growing tourism destinations on earth (+73% growth vs. 2019, UN Tourism 2025).

The gap we fill: Existing Uzbekistan tourism sites are dated, government-run, or thin SEO content farms. UzbekTrip is the first portal built with the production quality, photography, and structured depth that travelers already expect from guides to Japan, Italy, or Morocco.

One-line positioning: *"Uzbekistan, the way travelers actually need it — by city, not by category."*

Audience: International independent travelers (FIT — Free Independent Travelers) in the research and booking phase, aged 25–55, planning a first or second trip to Central Asia. Secondary audience: travel agents and tour operators sourcing structured city/route content.

Competitive set: Lonely Planet country pages, Trip.com destination guides, VisitUzbekistan.travel (the official government site — we're more current and more usable), TengriGuide (regional reference point).

What we are not: A booking engine, a forum, or a listicle farm. Every page should read like it was written by someone who has actually stood in the Registan at sunrise.

2. Logo

Located in `ideas/logo/`:

File	Use
<code>icon-mark.svg</code>	App icon, favicon, social avatar — dark lapis background
<code>icon-mark-on-cream.svg</code>	Same icon, light background variant
<code>logo-horizontal-dark.svg</code>	Primary lockup — site nav, dark UI, video intros
<code>logo-horizontal-light.svg</code>	Primary lockup — print, partner decks, light UI

The mark: An 8-pointed girih star — the geometric motif found in the tilework of the Registan, Shah-i-Zinda, and Ichon-Qala. It is not a generic globe-and-pin travel-logo cliché; it is specific to the region we cover, and it scales cleanly from a 16px favicon to a banner.

Construction: Icon mark + wordmark, separated by 14px minimum clear space (measured as the icon's own radius). Never stretch, rotate, recolor outside the approved palette, or place the wordmark above/below the icon — horizontal lockup only.

Minimum size: Icon mark alone: 16px. Horizontal lockup: 120px wide (below this, drop to icon-only).

Don'ts: - Don't recreate the star with rounded corners or fewer/more than 8 points - Don't place the dark lockup on any background lighter than `--lapis-mid` (`#2B5499`) — contrast fails - Don't add a drop shadow, outline, or gradient to the mark - Don't translate "UzbekTrip" — the brand name stays Latin-script across EN/RU/UZ; only surrounding copy is translated

3. Color System

These are the production CSS variables (`static/css/main.css`) — the brand book and the codebase share one source of truth.

Token	Hex	Use
<code>--lapis</code>	<code>#1A3A6B</code>	Primary brand color — nav, headers, dark sections. Named for lapis lazuli, historically mined in the region and used to color Silk Road tilework blue.

Token	Hex	Use
<code>--lapis-mid</code>	<code>#2B5499</code>	Secondary blue — links, hover states
<code>--gold</code>	<code>#C9A84C</code>	Accent — badges, CTAs, the star mark. Evokes Registan's gilded madrasa interiors.
<code>--gold-light</code>	<code>#E8C96D</code>	Lighter accent — headlines on dark backgrounds, hover states
<code>--turquoise</code>	<code>#2AABB8</code>	Tertiary accent — used sparingly (category tags, dome-blue callouts)
<code>--terracotta</code>	<code>#C4612A</code>	Warm accent — Eat section, food content, warning-adjacent UI
<code>--cream</code>	<code>#FAF6EE</code>	Page background — desert sand / aged paper, never pure white
<code>--ink</code>	<code>#1A1510</code>	Primary text, footer background
<code>--muted</code>	<code>#6B6258</code>	Secondary text, captions, metadata
<code>--border</code>	<code>#E8DFD0</code>	Hairlines, card borders

Rule of thumb: Lapis and cream carry 80% of every page. Gold is a spotlight color — used for one or two focal points per screen (a badge, a CTA, a headline accent), never as a fill for large areas. Terracotta is reserved for Eat/food contexts so the category has its own visual identity once it launches.

4. Typography

Role	Font	Where
Display / headlines	Cormorant Garamond (serif, weights 400/600/700, italic)	H1–H3, hero text, pull quotes, logo wordmark
Body / UI	DM Sans (weights 300/400/500/600)	Paragraphs, nav, buttons, forms, metadata

Why this pairing: Cormorant Garamond has the editorial, slightly classical weight of a travel magazine masthead — it reads as written-by-humans, not generated-by-template. DM Sans is a clean geometric sans that keeps long-form practical content (visa rules, SIM card prices) legible and modern. The contrast between the two is the brand's typographic signature — don't introduce a third typeface.

Usage rules: - Headlines: Cormorant Garamond, weight 700, occasional italic for emphasis within a headline (e.g. "*Discover* Uzbekistan") - Body copy: DM Sans 400, line-height 1.6–1.8 for readability in long-form city/sight descriptions - Labels, badges, nav: DM Sans 500/600, uppercase, letter-spacing 0.05–0.12em - Never set body copy in Cormorant Garamond — it's a display face only, legibility drops at small sizes

5. Imagery Style

- **Subject:** Architecture and people over abstract landscape. The Registan at golden hour outperforms a generic desert shot every time.
 - **Color grading:** Warm, slightly desaturated — avoid oversaturated HDR "Instagram filter" looks. Skies should look like skies, not neon.
 - **Composition:** Wide environmental shots for hero/cover images; close, human-scale shots (market stalls, craftspeople, food) for in-article imagery.
 - **People:** Always with informed consent context implied — candid, not staged-tourist-in-frame shots. Local people doing local things, not travelers posing.
 - **Aspect ratios:** 16:9 for article covers, 4:3 for city cards, 1:1 for gallery thumbnails — matches the grid system already built into the templates.
 - **Never use:** Stock photos with visible watermarks, AI-generated images presented as real locations (see Editorial Standards §6), or images that don't match the actual content (a Bukhara photo on a Samarkand page).
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6. Voice & Tone

We sound like: A well-traveled friend who's done the research, not a brochure and not a Reddit thread.

- **Confident, not breathless.** "The Registan is the single best reason to visit Samarkand" — not "OMG you HAVE to see this AMAZING place!!"
- **Specific over generic.** "Madrasas built 1417–1660" beats "ancient and historic."
- **Practical without being dry.** Visa rules and SIM card prices get the same care as the poetic intro — readers came here to actually plan a trip.
- **Respectful of the culture we're covering.** We are guests writing about a host country; avoid exoticizing language ("mysterious," "exotic," "untouched") that flattens Uzbekistan into a backdrop.

See `editorial-standards.md` for the full content style guide.

7. Application Examples

- **Nav bar:** Dark lapis, gold-light wordmark, white nav links — already live in `templates/base.html`
 - **Category badges:** Gold-on-cream pill badges, uppercase, letter-spaced — see `.news-cat-badge` in `static/css/main.css`
 - **CTAs:** Gold fill for primary actions, outline-white for secondary — `.btn-primary` / `.btn-outline`
 - **Section dividers:** Lapis full-width bands (Practical strip, Visa banner) break up long cream-background scroll — don't overuse, max 2–3 per page
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8. File Index

ideas/

└─ brand-book.md ← this file (PDF version: brand-book.pdf)

└─ editorial-standards.md (PDF version: editorial-standards.pdf)

└─ logo/

- |— icon-mark.svg
- |— icon-mark-on-cream.svg
- |— logo-horizontal-dark.svg
- |— logo-horizontal-light.svg

The `.md` files are the source of truth — regenerate the PDFs from them whenever either is updated, so the two formats never drift apart.

Production-ready raster exports (`logo.png` , `favicon-32.png` , `apple-touch-icon.png`) live in `static/img/` and should be regenerated from these SVGs whenever the mark changes, to keep brand book and shipped assets in sync.

UzbekTrip — uzbektrip.com